Mile Marker #5: Understanding My Money

The point is to know yourself a little better when it comes to money. Nobody needs a perfect budget.

> Leave this module with one honest insight and one realistic intention. There are no right or wrong financial situations here, and you never need to share a dollar amount.

> **For in-person classes.** Fill in this handout by hand, then upload a photo or scan to the Mile Marker #5 assignment in Blackboard. You can also type in the boxes and save it as a PDF. **Before you start,** finish these two Trail Tools. You never have to share them.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

QUESTION 1

What You Noticed

Look at your Dollar Tracker.

A strong answer *Names one real pattern from your tracker, like a category or a kind of small purchase, and says what it shows about your actual priorities.*

1. Name one pattern you noticed in your spending.

2. Explain what it shows about your priorities right now, even if they're different from what you'd say out loud.

QUESTION 2

Your Financial Reality

Describe your situation honestly, not for judgment but for clarity. No numbers needed.

A strong answer *Describes your situation honestly without numbers, names your biggest pressure and one support, and explains financial wellness in your own words, connected to your schoolwork or another part of your wellness.*

1. Choose the word that fits your financial life right now. *(choose one)*

☐ Tight ☐ Manageable ☐ Comfortable ☐ Complicated ☐ Somewhere in between

2. Name your biggest financial pressure this semester, and one resource, habit, or support that's helping.

3. Explain what financial wellness means to you, and how money affects your schoolwork or another part of your wellness.

QUESTION 3

One Realistic Next Step

It doesn't have to be dramatic. It just has to be honest and doable for your life right now.

A strong answer *Names one specific step, connects it to something you noticed, and explains why it's realistic for your life right now.*

1. Name one small thing you'll do differently, or keep doing, with money.

2. Explain why it's the right next step for where you are.

QUESTION 4

Your Zero-Based Budget

Look at the budget you built in the Budget Builder. No dollar amounts needed.

A strong answer *Explains why you chose your categories, says whether your budget balances to zero (and what you'll adjust if it doesn't), and names one thing building it showed you.*

1. Explain why you chose the categories you gave jobs to.

2. Did every dollar get a job? If not, say what you'll adjust.

3. Name one thing that giving every dollar a job showed you.

QUESTION 5

Keeping It Private

If you didn't use AI for this module, that's a complete answer. Just say so.

A strong answer *Names what you kept out of your prompts and how you worded things instead, or says plainly that you didn't use AI.*

1. If you used AI, describe what you left out of your prompts and how you described your situation instead. If you didn't, write "No AI this module."